

Sunset Valley faces petition against license plate readers

The Sunset Valley City Council will have a public hearing to discuss the upcoming budget, which includes the contract renewal of the APLRs.

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SUNSET VALLEY, Texas — Another city in Central Texas is facing pushback over its use of Automatic License Plate Readers (ALPRs), which are cameras used to capture vehicle information tied to crimes.

In Sunset Valley, a community south of Austin, there is a [petition](#) asking local leaders to remove the cameras that are currently in place.

The city council is set to have a public hearing on the upcoming budget cycle next month, which includes a renewal contract between Flock Safety and the Sunset Valley Police Department.

Police Chief Lenn Carter said he intends to push for the cameras to remain.

"I wouldn't recommend taking this tool away from any agency," Carter said.

According to the petition, there are concerns about federal agencies, such as Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE), having access to the data the cameras collect, which some believe will potentially lead to harassment and discrimination.

"There's laws in place for misusing that information. I think people are getting the tool confused with people who are using it illegally or allegedly using it illegally," Carter said. "I would recommend that people find out what they do, how they work and how the information is used, and if they have any proof of them being used illegally or improperly, they need to file a complaint."

Officials with Flock Safety have previously said the company does not have contracts with ICE or the U.S. Department of Homeland Security.

Currently, Sunset Valley has 16 ALPRs, but Carter said only 10 will remain because the city bought six of them with grant money that it did not receive again this year.

Back in June, the city of Austin chose to end its contract with Flock and not use the cameras anymore. In the same month, the city of San Marcos shot down the idea to add more cameras; instead, officials added new safeguards to the ones in place.

KVUE has reached out to the person who started the petition and will update this article if they respond.

